

Operator Guide

Day-to-day operations manual for the Nevada County Experience platform.

Who this is for

Whoever runs the platform week to week — chamber staff, county-IT, or a contractor on retainer. This guide assumes:

- You can use a web browser and File Explorer competently
- You can open a terminal (PowerShell or cmd) and type a command
- You don't need to write code

How to use this guide

Each section is a single, self-contained workflow with copy-paste commands. The Quick Reference page lists the most common tasks. When in doubt, jump to Troubleshooting at the end.

Quick Reference

Goal	Section	Time
Start the local server	Section 1	30 sec
Scrape & approve new events	Section 2 + 3	5 min
Run AI to clean up tags & areas	Section 4	~1 min
Add or edit an experience	Section 5	2 min/entry
Update the live demo on GitHub Pages	Section 6	2 min
Stop the server	Section 1c	5 sec
Something's broken	Section 7 (Troubleshooting)	varies
Where do files live?	Section 8 (File map)	reference

1. Starting & stopping the local server

The local Flask server is required for the admin panel, AI Categorize, and live event scraping.

1a. Easiest: double-click the launcher

In the project folder there's a file named `start_server.bat`. **Double-click it**. A console window opens, prints "Running on `http://127.0.0.1:5000`", and stays open while the server runs.

Tip: right-click `start_server.bat` → Send to → Desktop (create shortcut), so you can launch from the desktop.

1b. From PowerShell (alternative)

```
cd "C:\Users\<your-user>\Documents\nevada-county-experience"
python server.py
```

You should see:

```
=====
Nevada County Experience -- Local Server
http://127.0.0.1:5000/
Press Ctrl+C to stop
=====
* Running on http://127.0.0.1:5000
```

1c. To stop the server

In the console window where it's running, press **Ctrl+C** once. The window stays open — you can type the start command again, or just close the window.

1d. Open the site in your browser

Go to **`http://localhost:5000`** while the server is running. Bookmark it.

2. Scrape new events

Pulls fresh events from KVMR, Eventbrite, NC Chamber, GV Chamber, and other sources. Run weekly or whenever you want fresh data.

2a. From the admin panel (easiest)

1. Make sure the server is running (Section 1)
2. Open `http://localhost:5000` in your browser
3. Click **■ Manage Database** in the top-right corner
4. Click the **■ Events Queue** tab
5. Click the green **■ Update Now** button (top right)
6. Wait 30-90 seconds — the status bar shows "■ Scraping in progress..."
7. When it finishes, switch to the **Pending** tab — new events appear there

2b. From the command line (advanced)

```
cd "C:\Users\<your-user>\Documents\nevada-county-experience"
python scraper\event_scraper.py
```

```
# Or scrape a single source:
python scraper\event_scraper.py --site "Nevada City Chamber"
```

What gets scraped

Source	Method	Typical volume
KVMR	Tribe Events RSS feed	~430 events / 6-month window
Eventbrite Nevada	Headless Chrome	~10 events
NC Chamber	Static HTML page	~10 events
GV Chamber	Elementor page	~5 events
The Union	RSS feed	Varies
Go Nevada	Headless Chrome (often Cloudflare-blocked)	Varies

3. Approve, dismiss, prune events

After scraping, new events sit in the Pending queue. Approve to publish; dismiss to hide permanently.

3a. Approve individual events

In the Events Queue → Pending tab:

- ✓ **Approve** button: event becomes visible to the public
- ✕ **Dismiss** button: event hidden permanently. Won't come back even if scraped again.
- Click the event title to open the source page in a new tab

3b. Approve them all at once

When the queue is mostly noise-free (typical after AI categorization flags low-quality items), use bulk approval:

"Approve All" button — approves everything pending whose date is today or in the future. Past-dated pending events are auto-dismissed (prevents stale items from re-appearing).

3c. Filter the queue

Above the table you'll find filter controls:

- **Status:** Pending / Approved / Dismissed (one tab each)
- **Source:** dropdown — see only KVMR, only Eventbrite, etc.
- **Date range:** two date inputs — narrow to a specific window

3d. Pruning past events

The pruner removes:

- Pending or approved events whose date has passed
- Dismissed events older than 60 days (long enough to prevent re-import)

Note: public visitors never see expired events — the site filters them out client-side regardless of pruning. Pruning is queue housekeeping, not a visitor-facing concern.

When pruning runs:

- **Automatically** on every scrape (right before merging fresh events)
- **Manually** via the ■ Prune Past button at the top of the Events Queue

- **Manually** via API — POST /api/events/prune

Action item — schedule the scraper: the scraper does not run on a schedule out of the box. Set up a nightly run via Windows Task Scheduler (chamber laptop) or cron / systemd timer (VPS) so the queue stays current and pruning fires automatically. Without a schedule, expired events accumulate in the queue (still hidden from visitors) until someone clicks Update Now or ■ Prune Past.

4. AI Categorize (Claude Haiku)

Cleans up tags, infers venue and area, scores quality. Optional but highly recommended for KVMR events.

4a. One-time setup (do this once)

1. Get an Anthropic API key at console.anthropic.com
2. Set a \$5/month spending cap in your Anthropic billing settings (safety net)
3. Open `scraper/config.py` in a text editor
4. Add this line at the top: `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY = "sk-ant-..."`
5. Save the file. Restart the server.

4b. Run it

1. Open the admin Events Queue (Manage Database → Events Queue)
2. Click the purple **AI Categorize** button
3. A prompt asks how many events to process — leave blank for all, or enter a number for a test run
4. Status bar shows "■ Categorizing..." for ~1-3 minutes
5. When done, refresh the page — events show refined area, venue, tags

4c. Cost

Run pattern	Per run	Monthly equiv
First-time bulk run (all 460 events)	~\$0.30	one-time
Weekly: only new events	\$0.04 - \$0.13	\$0.20-\$0.50/mo
Daily: only new events	\$0.01 - \$0.02	\$0.30-\$0.60/mo

4d. What if you don't want to use AI?

Skip the API key setup. The button greys out to **AI (no key)**. Everything else still works — events just keep their basic scraper-assigned tags.

5. Add or edit an experience

The 161 curated experiences (Empire Mine, Lola Restaurant, B&Bs, campgrounds, etc.) live in an inline-editable table.

5a. Open the editor

1. Server running, browser open at `http://localhost:5000`
2. Click **■ Manage Database** top right
3. Stay on the **Experiences** tab (it's the default)

5b. Edit a field

1. Find the row by typing in the search input or sorting by clicking a column header
2. Click directly on the cell you want to change (Name, Description, Hours, etc.)
3. Type the new value
4. Click **■ Save All** in the toolbar — green flash confirms saved

5c. Add a new entry

1. Click **+ Add Experience** in the toolbar
2. A new blank row appears at the bottom
3. Fill in: Name, Description, Area, Type, Hours, Notes, Tags, Season, URL, Lat, Lng
4. Click **■ Save All**

Required fields for the entry to show: Name, Area, Type, Tags. Everything else is optional but recommended.

5d. Manage tags

Click **■ Edit Tags** in the toolbar to open the tag taxonomy editor. Add, rename, or delete tags. Changes propagate to all filtering immediately.

5e. Delete an entry

Click the **×** button at the right end of the row. Confirms before deleting. Click **■ Save All** to persist.

6. Update the live GitHub Pages demo

After scraping fresh events or editing experiences, push the updates so the public demo at liammlrb-eng.github.io/nevada-county-experiences reflects them.

6a. The full refresh workflow

```
# 1. Make sure server is running, then in admin panel:
#   • ■ Update Now (scrape fresh events)
#   • Wait for completion
#   • ■ AI Categorize (optional, recommended)
#   • Approve All (or review individually)

# 2. From PowerShell, push the updated files to GitHub:
cd "C:\Users\<your-user>\Documents\nevada-county-experience"
git add scraper_output/events.json
git add index.html           # if you edited any experiences
git commit -m "events update – <date>"
git push

# 3. Wait ~1 minute. The live demo updates automatically.
```

6b. What gets updated where

What	Where it lives	Pushed to GitHub?
Public events	scraper_output/events.json	Yes
Curated experiences (161)	index.html	Yes
Itinerary suggestions (admin)	managed via Manage Database	Yes
Scraper source URLs	scraper/sources.json	Yes
API keys (Google, Anthropic)	scraper/config.py	NO — gitignored
Local backups, cache files	.bak, __pycache__	NO — gitignored

6c. Cache caveat

GitHub Pages caches static files for ~10 minutes by default. If a visitor has the page open while you push an update, they'll see the old data until they hard-refresh (**Ctrl+F5** on Windows / **Cmd+Shift+R** on Mac). New visitors get the latest immediately. Not a problem for tourism use — visitors don't refresh every minute.

6d. Recommended cadence

When	What
Just before peak season (Apr, Oct)	Full scrape + AI + manual review + push
Weekly during season	Scrape + Approve All + push
Monthly off-season	Scrape + push
After major content update	Edit experiences locally + push

7. Troubleshooting

Most common issues and how to fix them.

Symptom	Fix
Server won't start: "python is not recognized as an internal or external command, batch file or shell script"	Python isn't in your PATH. Reinstall Python from python.org and check "Add Python to PATH" during installation.
Server won't start: "Address already in use: port 5000 is busy"	Port 5000 is busy. Either close the previous server window, or run: <code>python server.py --port 5001</code>
Site loads but Events tab is empty	On the local server: open Manage Database → Events Queue → click Approve All on pending events.
■ Update Now hangs forever	Selenium/Chromium issue. Close the browser, restart server, try again. If persistent, try a single session.
■ AI Categorize button is greyed out	No Anthropic API key set. See Section 4a. Restart the server after adding the key.
■ AI Categorize fails with "API error 401"	Invalid API key. Check for typos in scraper/config.py. Generate a new key at console.anthropic.com.
■ AI Categorize fails with "rate limit"	Hitting Anthropic API limits. Lower batch size (edit ai_categorize.py: <code>--batch-size 5</code>) or wait an hour.
Edits aren't saving	Click the green ■ Save All button after editing — auto-save isn't enabled for the admin table.
Lost an experience after deleting	Browser localStorage keeps a recent backup. Open browser DevTools (F12) → Application → Local Storage → delete.
GitHub Pages not updating after push	Wait 2 minutes (deploy time). Then hard-refresh (Ctrl+F5). If still stale, check repo Settings → Pages → select GitHub Pages.
"Permission denied" pushing to GitHub	Your GitHub credentials expired or you don't have write access. In PowerShell: <code>git push --force</code>

8. File map — where things live

Quick reference for what's in the project folder.

nevada-county-experience/	
■■■ index.html	← The whole frontend (everything visitors see)
■■■ server.py	← Flask web server (runs locally)
■■■ start_server.bat	← Double-click to start the server
■■■ scraper/	
■ ■■■ event_scraper.py	← Main scraper (orchestrates all sources)
■ ■■■ ai_categorize.py	← AI cleanup (Claude Haiku)
■ ■■■ auto_tagger.py	← Keyword-based pre-tagging
■ ■■■ config.py	← API KEYS – never committed to GitHub
■ ■■■ sources.json	← Scraper source URL list
■ ■■■ site_scrapers/	← One file per source
■ ■■■ kvmr.py	
■ ■■■ eventbrite_nevada.py	
■ ■■■ nevada_city_chamber.py	
■ ■■■ gv_chamber.py	
■ ■■■ the_union.py	
■ ■■■ ...	
■■■ scraper_output/	
■ ■■■ events.json	← The live event database (committed)
■ ■■■ candidates.json	← Scraper debug data (gitignored)
■ ■■■ snapshots/	← Rendered HTML for selector debug (gitignored)
■■■ demo_pitch.pdf	← County presentation deck
■■■ operator_guide.pdf	← This file
■■■ generate_demo_pdf.py	← Source for demo_pitch.pdf
■■■ generate_operator_guide.py	← Source for this file
■■■ CLAUDE.md	← Project context for future contributors
■■■ .gitignore	← What never gets committed

8a. The four files you'll touch most

File	When you touch it
index.html	Edit experiences via Manage Database (admin panel) — never edit by hand
scraper_output/events.json	Updated automatically by scraping — commit + push after scrapes
scraper/config.py	API keys — edit once during setup, never commit
scraper/sources.json	Add/disable scraper sources — edit via ■ Scraper Sources tab

8b. Logs & diagnostics

When something's wrong, look here:

Where	What it tells you
Server console window	Live request log + Python errors. Keep visible while debugging.
Browser DevTools console	F12 → Console tab. Frontend errors and warnings.
scraper_output/snapshots/	When a scraper fails: <code>python scraper/event_scraper.py --discover --</code>

9. Annual tasks & emergency contacts

9a. Once-a-year checklist

- **Spring:** walk through every experience entry — verify hours, URLs, and that the venue still exists. Use Manage Database → Experiences. Budget 4-6 hours.
- **Spring:** review all 9 vibes — are the photos still working? Are the taglines still accurate? Edit if needed.
- **Summer:** pre-festival-season scrape + AI categorize + manual review. Push to GitHub.
- **Fall:** review the Suggested Experiences — are the published itineraries still relevant? Update photos and stops.
- **Anytime:** domain renewal — set a calendar reminder 90 days before expiry.
- **Anytime:** backup test — once a year, restore events.json from a tarball backup to a test folder, verify the file loads.

9b. Emergency contact ladder

When something breaks and you need help, in order:

- **1. Try Section 7 (Troubleshooting)** first — covers 80% of issues
- **2. Check the GitHub repo Issues tab** — has anyone reported this?
- **3. Original developer / contractor** — keep their email pinned
- **4. County IT** — for server-level / hosting issues
- **5. Anthropic support** — for AI billing / API key issues (support@anthropic.com)
- **6. Hosting provider support** — DigitalOcean / Linode / etc., for server downtime

9c. Before calling for help — gather this

Info	Why it helps
What you tried	List the steps that led to the problem
Exact error text	Copy-paste from console window or browser. Screenshot if needed.
When it started	After a scrape? After a push? After Windows update?
Which environment	Local server? GitHub Pages? Just the admin panel?
Last successful action	"Scrape worked yesterday at 3 PM" — helpful baseline

Final note

"Most problems with this platform aren't crises — they're small gaps in process. A scrape fails, a tag goes stale, a photo URL breaks. The system is designed to keep working even when individual pieces don't. Don't panic; check Section 7; ask for help if needed."